

Area of Study 3: Developments in Instrumental Jazz 1910 to the present day

Outline	Learners should study the development of instrumental jazz music from 1910 to the present day: • study examples in depth of recorded jazz performances from the period of study using live performances, recordings and scores as appropriate • use attentive listening and contextual knowledge to analyse, evaluate and make critical judgements about the repertoire • use technical vocabulary to communicate a sophisticated understanding of jazz music and its context.
Focus for learning	Learners should analyse, explain and compare developments in styles of jazz, including: • early jazz • swing • bebop • cool jazz • hard bop • avant-garde and free jazz • jazz-rock fusion • contemporary approaches to jazz. Learners should study and understand how jazz musicians use musical elements, including: • improvisation • swing • syncopation • polyrhythms • harmony and tonality • blues • blue notes and decoration of notes (vibrato, pitch bend, smear etc.) • timbre • organisation of pitch, melodically and harmonically • devices, e.g. chorus, call and response, riff or ostinato • roles of solo and ensemble, rhythm section (drums, bass etc.). Learners should study and understand the conditions and context in which jazz music was created and performed, including: • its origins in New Orleans and elsewhere • its dissemination to a wider audience in the United States of America and Europe • changes in the popularity and commercial viability of jazz • the role of radio and recording in the development of jazz • working conditions for jazz musicians • challenges and issues for jazz performers and composers working today.
Prescribed works	No prescribed works for this Area of Study.